



Spain and Portugal

Spanish families tend to eat dinner late, at around 9 pm. So after school, children eat a snack called a merienda.

THE COUNTRIES OF SPAIN AND PORTUGAL share an area of land called the Iberian Peninsula. In the north, this land is cut off from the rest of Europe by the Pyrenees Mountains, while to the south, it is separated from Africa by the Strait of Gibraltar. The region was once ruled by Islamic people from north Africa, known as the Moors. Evidence of their culture can still be seen in buildings in the cities of Andalucía. The Moors were eventually defeated in 1492 and, for a while, Portugal came under Spanish control, as did much of Europe. During the 20th century, both

countries were ruled by brutal dictatorships, which were overthrown in the 1970s. They are now modern democracies and popular tourist destinations.



HARVESTING CORK

Cork is made from the outer bark of the evergreen cork oak tree. The bark is carefully stripped off, flattened, laid out in sheets, and then left to dry. The cork is used for many products, such as stoppers for wine bottles, matting, and tiles. Portugal is the world's leading exporter of cork.

LISBON

Portugal's capital city is Lisbon, which is situated at the mouth of the River Tagus on a series of steep hills and valleys. In 1755, two-thirds of the city was completely destroyed by an earthquake and tidal wave but was rebuilt with beautiful squares and public buildings. Many explorers have set sail from Lisbon in their quest to find new lands.



Trams are a feature of Lisbon streets and a popular form of transportation for both the locals and tourists.

FISHING

Spain and Portugal have well-developed fishing industries with large-scale fleets and many smaller local fleets. However, overfishing along Portugal's coast and out in the north Atlantic has put many people's livelihoods at risk. Spain is still one of Europe's top fishing nations, with catches of fish, molluscs, and crustaceans reaching around 1,100 tons per year.

